The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue VII in E-flat major (a 8): Fuga a due cori

Two four-voice choirs (Coro I left, Coro II right)

Claude / Sam

Coro I: exposition, subject (soprano)

Coro I: answer (alto) + countersubject

Coro I: subject (tenor)

Allegro festivo (♩ = 80)

Coro I rectus (subject, E-flat)

Coro I rectus (tonal answer, B-flat)

Coro I rectus (subject, E-flat)

I Soprano

I Alto

I Tenor

I Bass

II Soprano

II Alto

II Tenor

II Bass

7

Coro I: answer (bass)

Coro II: the mirror exposition (bass first)

Coro I rectus (tonal answer, B-flat)

Coro II inversus (mirror of the answer: A-flat)

Coro II inversus (mirror of b1)

S1

A1

T1
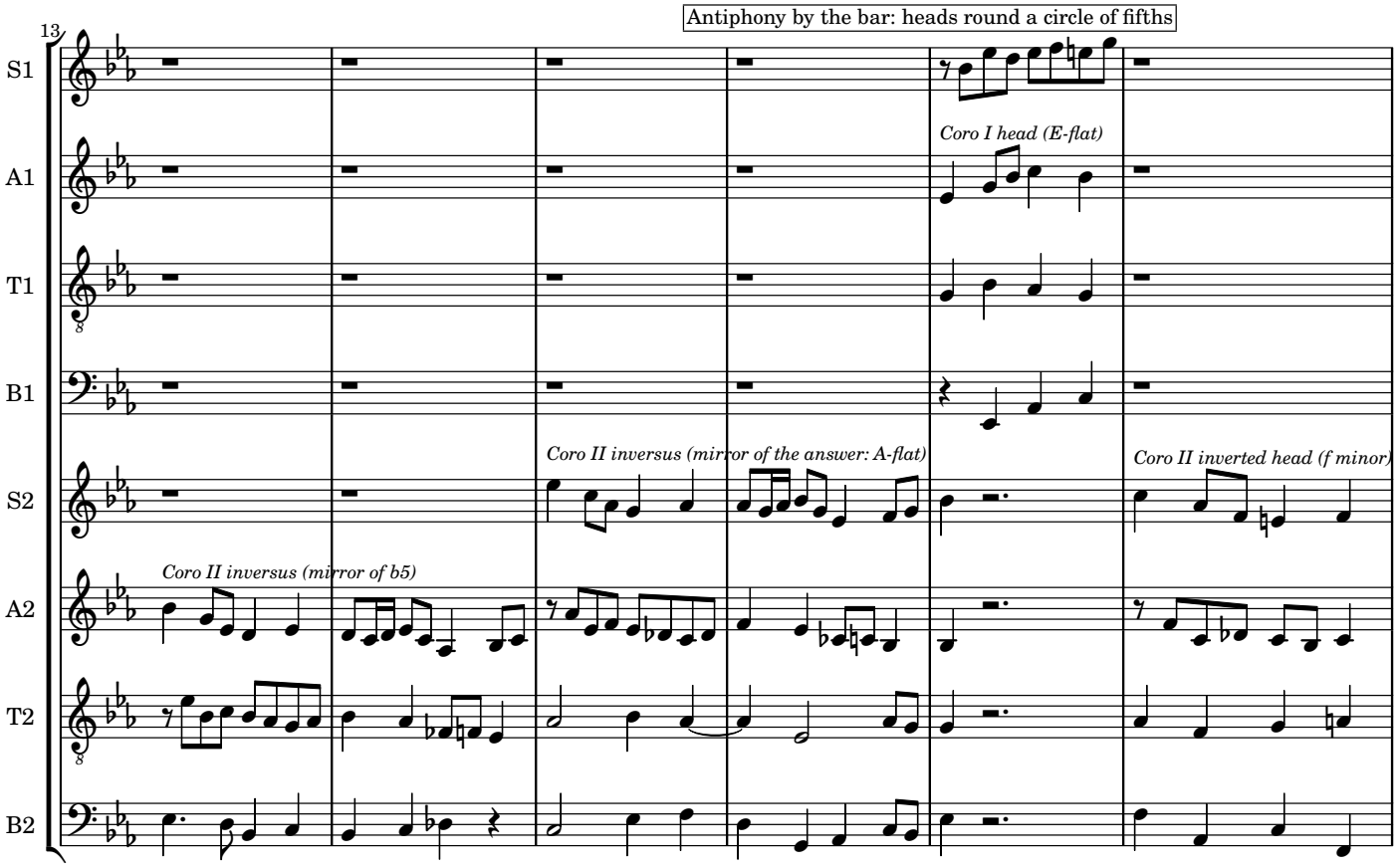
B1
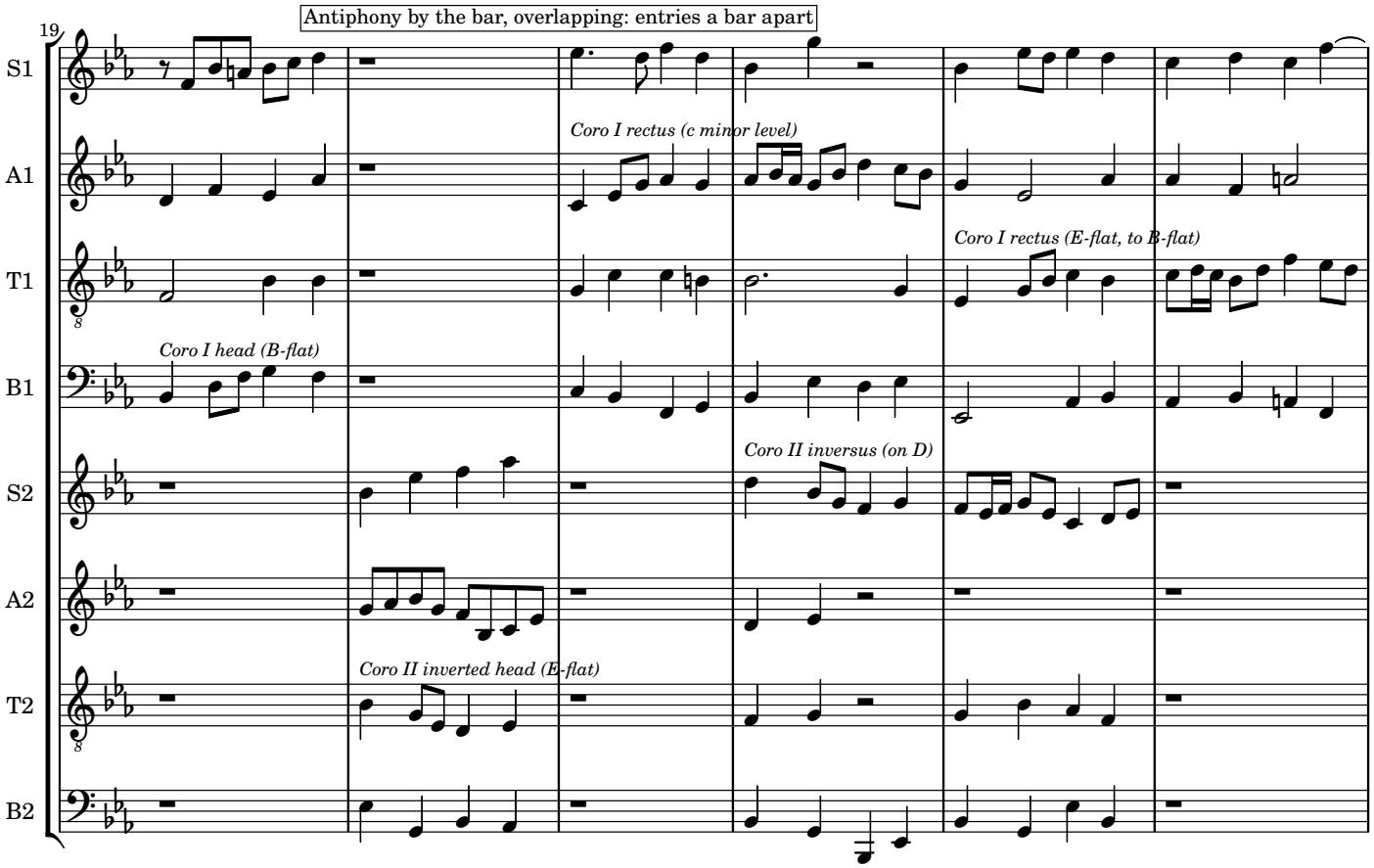
S2
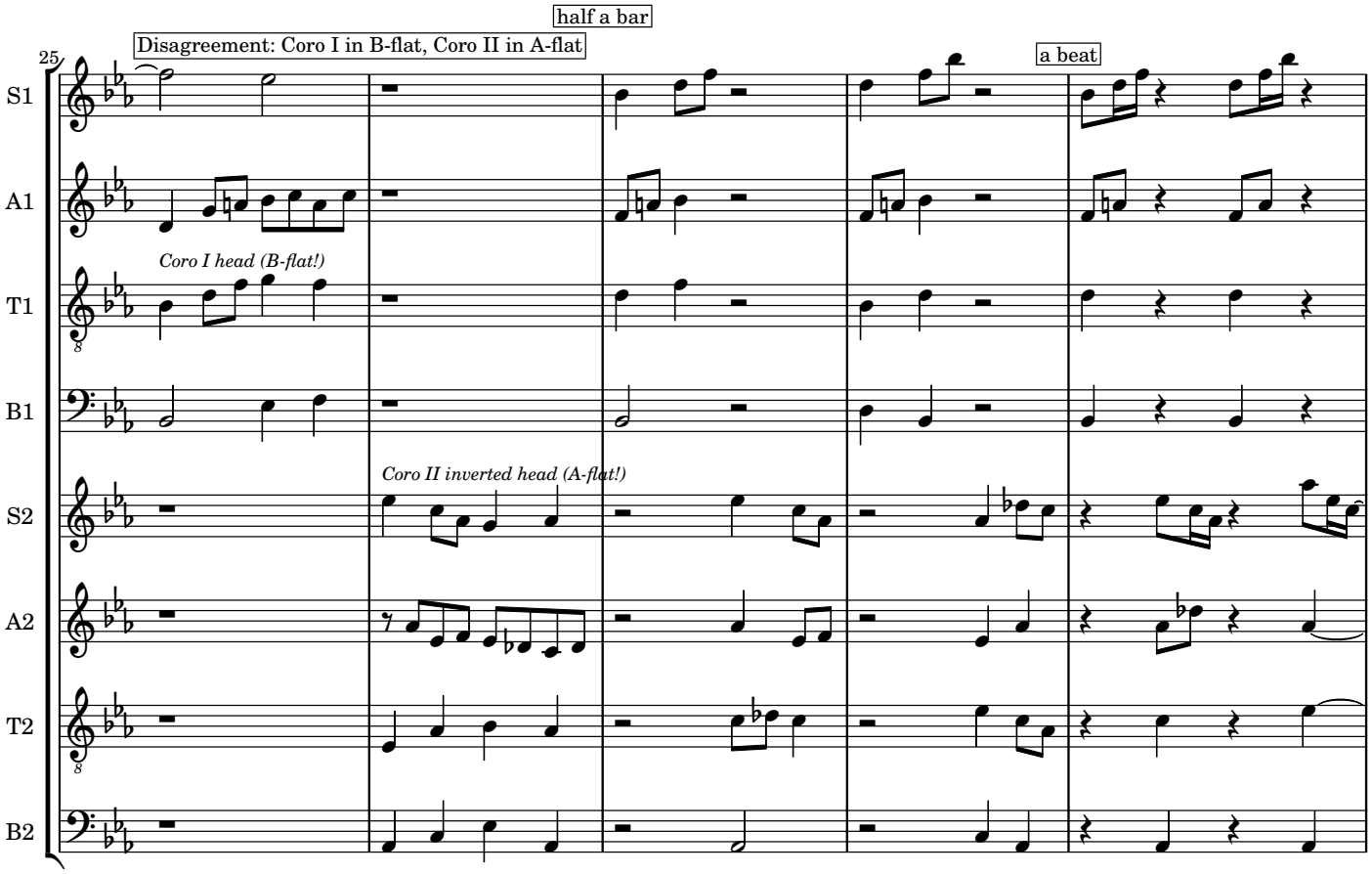
A2
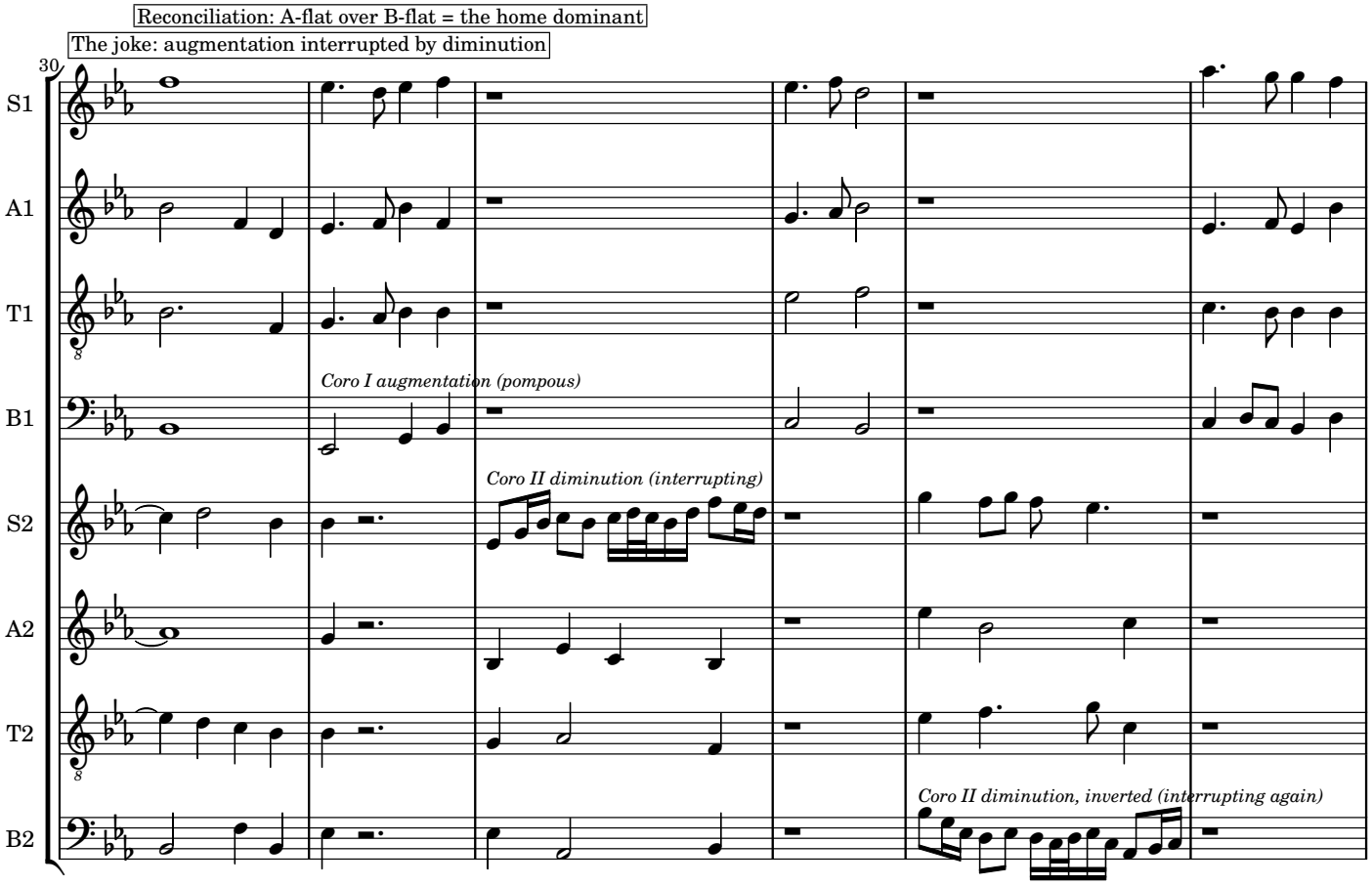
T2
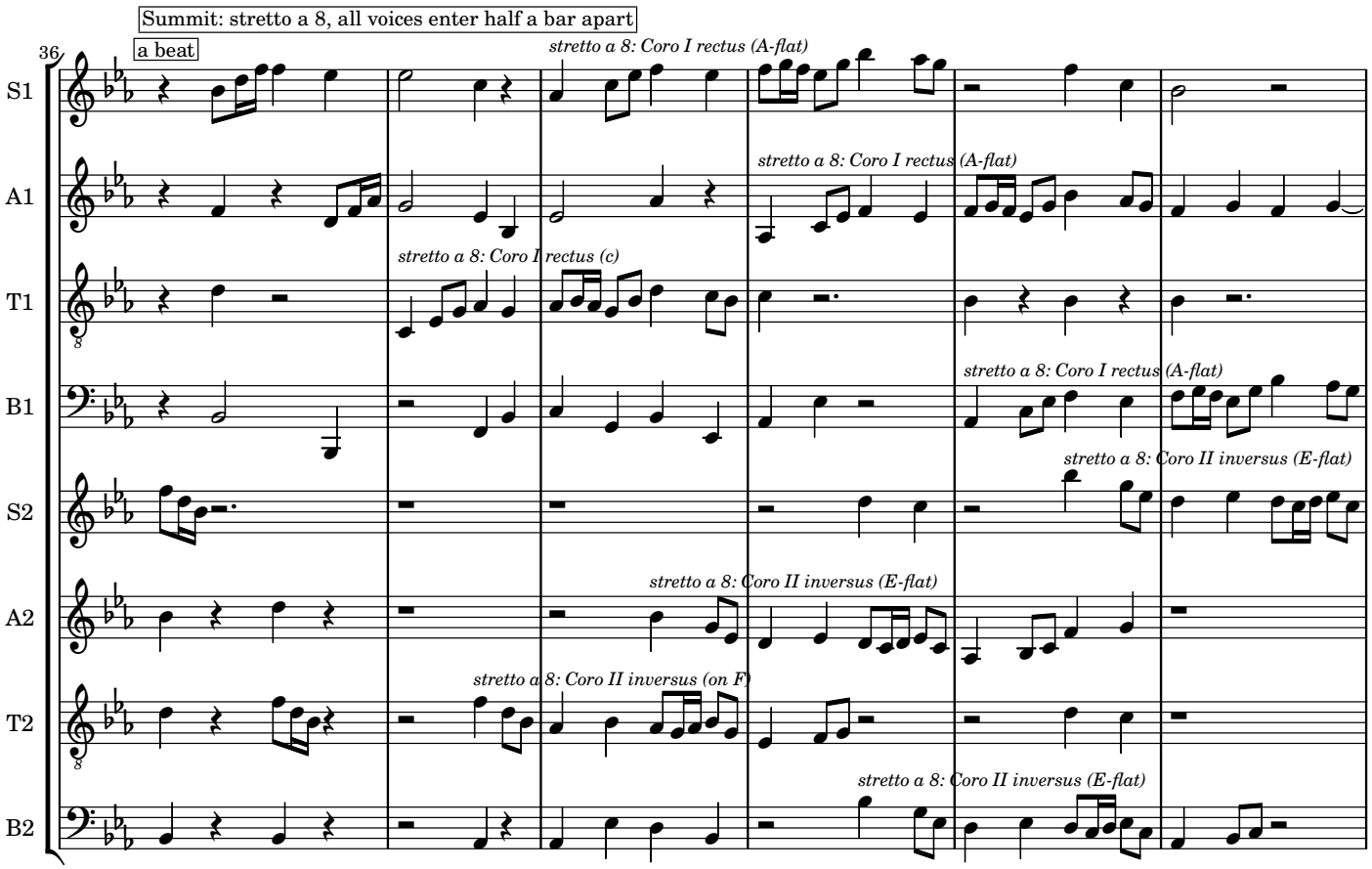
B2

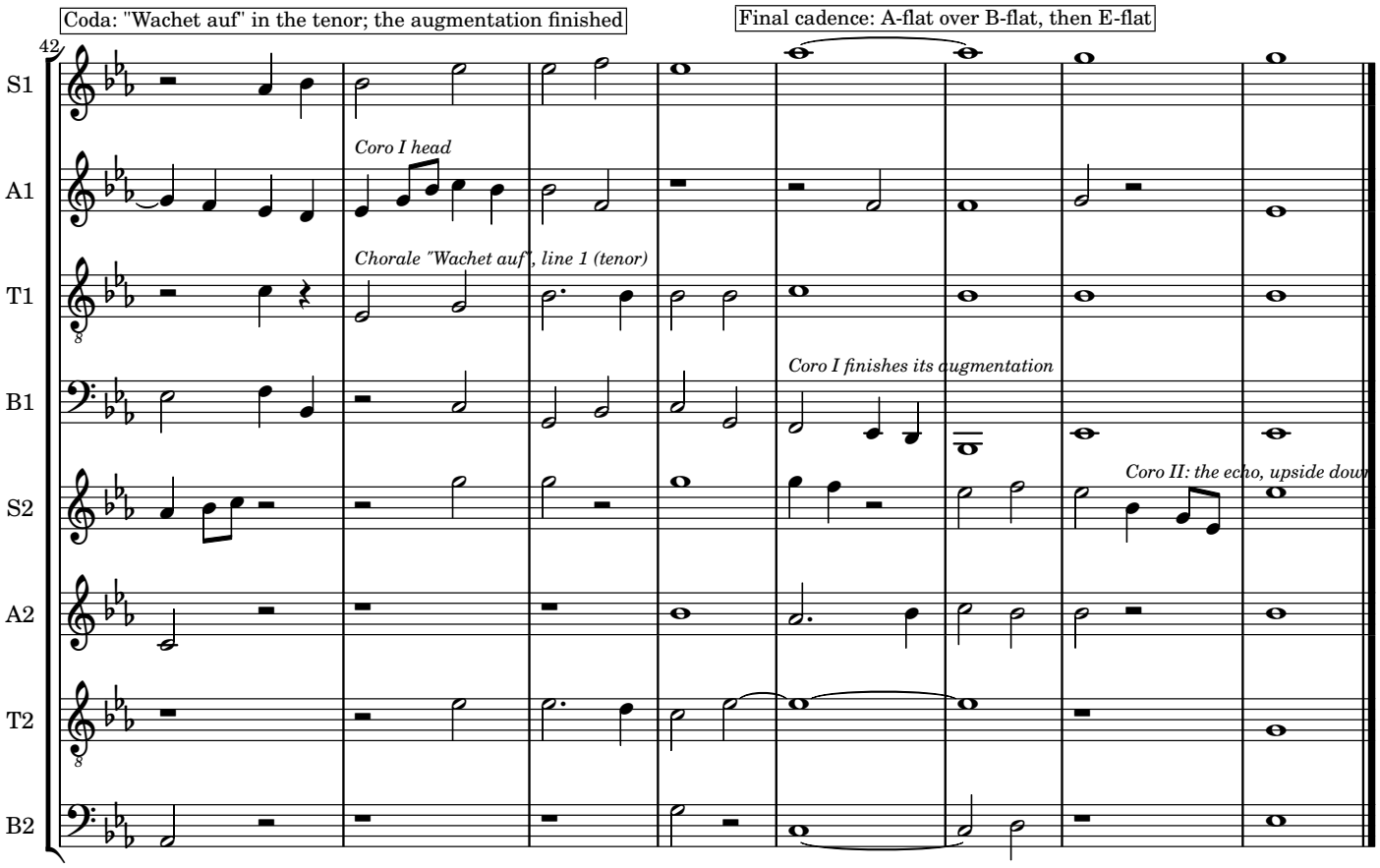

13
Antiphony by the bar: heads round a circle of fifths
S1
A1
T1
B1
S2
A2
T2
B2
Coro I head (E-flat)
Coro II inversus (mirror of the answer: A-flat)
Coro II inverted head (f minor)
Coro II inversus (mirror of b5)


19
Antiphony by the bar, overlapping: entries a bar apart
S1
A1
T1
B1
S2
A2
T2
B2
Coro I rectus (c minor level)
Coro I rectus (E-flat, to B-flat)
Coro I head (B-flat)
Coro II inversus (on D)
Coro II inverted head (E-flat)


half a bar
Disagreement: Coro I in B-flat, Coro II in A-flat
25
a beat
S1
A1
Coro I head (B-flat!)
T1
B1
Coro II inverted head (A-flat!)
S2
A2
T2
B2


Reconciliation: A-flat over B-flat = the home dominant
The joke: augmentation interrupted by diminution
30
S1
A1
T1
Coro I augmentation (pompous)
B1
Coro II diminution (interrupting)
S2
A2
T2
Coro II diminution, inverted (interrupting again)
B2


Summit: stretto a 8, all voices enter half a bar apart
a beat
36
S1
A1
T1
B1
S2
A2
T2
B2
stretto a 8: Coro I rectus (A-flat)
stretto a 8: Coro I rectus (A-flat)
stretto a 8: Coro I rectus (c)
stretto a 8: Coro I rectus (A-flat)
stretto a 8: Coro II inversus (E-flat)
stretto a 8: Coro II inversus (E-flat)
stretto a 8: Coro II inversus (on F)
stretto a 8: Coro II inversus (E-flat)


Coda: "Wachet auf" in the tenor; the augmentation finished
Final cadence: A-flat over B-flat, then E-flat
42
S1
A1
T1
B1
S2
A2
T2
B2
Coro I head
Chorale "Wachet auf", line 1 (tenor)
Coro I finishes its augmentation
Coro II: the echo, upside down